

7. Ἐπεὶ δὲ κατεστρατοπεδεύσαντο, συνεκάλεσεν ὁ Κῦρος τοὺς ἐπικαιρίους καὶ ἔλεξεν, Ἄνδρες σύμμαχοι, τεθεάμεθα μὲν κύκλῳ τὴν πόλιν· ἐγὼ δὲ ὅπως μὲν ἂν τις τείχη οὕτως ἰσχυρὰ καὶ ὑψηλὰ προσμαχόμενος ἔλοι οὐκ ἐνορᾶν μοι δοκῶ· ὅσῳ δὲ πλείους ἄνθρωποι ἐν τῇ πόλει εἰσὶν, ἐπείπερ οὐ μάχονται ἐξιόντες, τοσούτῳ ἂν θάττον λιμῶ αὐτοὺς ἡγοῦμαι ἀλῶναι. εἰ μή τιν' οὖν ἄλλον τρόπον ἔχετε λέγειν, τούτῳ πολιορκητέους φημὶ εἶναι τοὺς ἄνδρας.

8. Καὶ ὁ Χρυσάντας εἶπεν, Ὁ δὲ ποταμός, ἔφη, οὗτος οὐ διὰ μέσης τῆς πόλεως ῥεῖ πλάτος ἔχων πλείον ἢ ἐπὶ δύο στάδια;

Ναὶ μὰ Δι', ἔφη ὁ Γωβρύας, καὶ βάθος γ' ὡς οὐδ' ἂν δύο ἄνδρες ὁ ἕτερος ἐπὶ τοῦ ἑτέρου ἐστηκώς τοῦ ὕδατος ὑπερέχοιεν· ὥστε τῷ ποταμῷ ἔτι ἰσχυροτέρα ἐστὶν ἡ πόλις ἢ τοῖς τείχεσι.

9. Καὶ ὁ Κῦρος, Ταῦτα μὲν, ἔφη, ὦ Χρυσάντα, ἐῷμεν ὅσα κρείττω ἐστὶ τῆς ἡμετέρας δυνάμεως· διαμετρησαμένους δὲ χρὴ ὡς τάχιστα τὸ μέρος ἐκάστους¹ ἡμῶν ὀρύττειν τάφρον ὡς πλατυτάτην καὶ βαθυτάτην, ὅπως ὅτι ἐλαχίστων ἡμῖν τῶν φυλάκων δέη.

10. Οὕτω δὲ κύκλῳ διαμετρήσας περὶ τὸ τεῖχος, ἀπολιπὼν ὅσον τύρσεσι μεγάλαις ἀπὸ τοῦ

¹ ἐκάστους Madvig, Breitenbach, Hug, Marchant, Gemoll ; ἐκάστου xzFV, Dindorf ; ἑκαστον D.

CYROPAEDIA, VII. v. 7-10

7. When they had encamped, Cyrus called together his staff-officers and said : " Friends and allies, we have viewed the city on every side. But I am sure I cannot see how any one could take by storm walls so massive and so high ; but the more men there are in the city, the sooner they can, I think, be brought by famine to capitulate, seeing that they will not come out and fight. Therefore, unless you have some other method to suggest, I propose that we use this method of laying siege to those gentlemen."

Cyrus plans
for a siege

8. " But," said Chrysantas, " does not this river flow through the midst of the city ? And it is more than two stadia in width."

" Aye, by Zeus," said Gobryas, " and its depth is such that two men, one standing on the other's shoulders, would not reach the surface of the water, so that the city is better defended by the river than by its walls."

9. " Chrysantas," Cyrus answered, " let us not trouble ourselves with that which is beyond our powers ; but we must apportion the work among ourselves as quickly as possible, to each contingent its proper share, and dig a ditch as wide and as deep as possible, so that we may require only as many men on guard as are absolutely indispensable."

He proposes
to divert the
Euphrates

10. Accordingly, he took measurements in a circle round about the city, leaving just enough room by the river for the erection of large towers, and began

ποταμοῦ, ὥρυττεν ἔνθεν καὶ ἔνθεν τοῦ τείχους τάφρον ὑπερμεγέθη, καὶ τὴν γῆν ἀνέβαλλον πρὸς ἑαυτοὺς. 11. καὶ πρῶτον μὲν πύργους ἐπὶ τῷ ποταμῷ ὠκοδόμει, φοίνιξι θεμελιώσας οὐ μείον ἢ πλεθριαίοις—εἰσὶ γὰρ καὶ μείζονες ἢ τοσοῦτοι τὸ μῆκος πεφυκότες· καὶ γὰρ δὴ πιεζόμενοι οἱ φοίνικες ὑπὸ βάρους ἄνω κυρτοῦνται, ὥσπερ οἱ ὄνοι οἱ καινήλιοι. 12. τούτους δ' ὑπετίθει τούτου ἔνεκα [ὅπως ὅτι μάλιστα εἰκοι πολιορκήσειν παρασκευαζομένῳ],¹ ὥς εἰ καὶ διαφύγοι ὁ ποταμὸς εἰς τὴν τάφρον, μὴ ἀνέλοι τοὺς πύργους. ἀνίστη δὲ καὶ ἄλλους πολλοὺς πύργους ἐπὶ τῆς ἀμβολάδος γῆς, ὅπως ὅτι πλείστα φυλακτήρια εἶη.

13. Οἱ μὲν δὴ ταῦτ' ἐποίουν· οἱ δ' ἐν τῷ τείχει κατεγέλων τῆς πολιορκίας, ὥς ἔχοντες τὰπιτήδεια πλέον ἢ εἴκοσιν ἑτῶν.

Ἀκούσας δὲ ταῦτα ὁ Κῦρος τὸ στράτευμα κατένειμε δώδεκα μέρη, ὥς μῆνα τοῦ ἐνιαυτοῦ ἕκαστον τὸ μέρος φυλάξον. 14. οἱ δὲ αὖ Βαβυλώνιοι ἀκούσαντες ταῦτα πολὺν ἔτι μᾶλλον κατεγέλων, ἐννοούμενοι εἰ σφᾶς Φρύγες καὶ Λυδοὶ καὶ Ἀράβιοι καὶ Καππαδόκαι φυλάξοιεν, οὓς σφίσιν ἐνόμιζον πάντας εὐμενεστέρους εἶναι ἢ Πέρσαις.

15. Καὶ αἱ μὲν τάφροι ἤδη ὀρωρυγμέναι ἦσαν. ὁ δὲ Κῦρος ἐπειδὴ ἐορτὴν τοιαύτην ἐν τῇ Βαβυλῶνι ἤκουσεν εἶναι, ἐν ἣ πάντες Βαβυλώνιοι ὅλην τὴν νύκτα πίνουσι καὶ κωμάζουσιν, ἐν ταύτῃ, ἐπειδὴ τάχιστα συνεσκότασε, λαβὼν πολλοὺς

¹ ὅπως . . . παρασκευαζομένῳ MSS. ; bracketed by Breitenbach, Hug, Marchant, Gemoll ; Dindorf brackets τούτους . . . πύργους.

CYROPAEDIA, VII. v. 10-15

on either side of the city to dig an immense trench ; and the earth from it they threw up on their own side of the ditch. 11. First of all, he began to build towers by the river, laying his foundations with the trunks of date-palms not less than a hundred feet long—and they grow even taller than that. And they were good material for this purpose, for it is a well known fact that date-palms, when under heavy pressure, bend upward like the backs of pack-asses. 12. These he used as “mud-sills,” in order that, even if the river should break into his trench above, it might not carry his towers away. And he erected many other towers besides upon the breast-works of earth, so that he might have as many watch-towers as possible.

13. Thus, then, his men were employed, while the enemy upon the walls laughed his siege-works to scorn, in the belief that they had provisions enough for more than twenty years.

Upon hearing of this, Cyrus divided his army into twelve parts as if intending each part to be responsible for sentry duty during one month of each year ; 14. but the Babylonians, in their turn, when they heard of that, laughed much more scornfully still, at the thought of Phrygians and Lydians and Arabians and Cappadocians keeping guard against them, for they considered all these to be more friendly to them than to the Persians.

15. At last the ditches were completed. Then, when he heard that a certain festival had come round in Babylon, during which all Babylon was accustomed to drink and revel all night long, Cyrus took a large number of men, just as soon as it was dark, and

The river
is turned

ἀνθρώπους ἀνεστόμωσε τὰς τάφρους πρὸς τὸν ποταμόν. 16. ὥς δὲ τοῦτο ἐγένετο, τὸ ὕδωρ κατὰ τὰς τάφρους ἐχώρει ἐν τῇ νυκτί, ἡ δὲ διὰ τῆς πόλεως τοῦ ποταμοῦ ὁδὸς πορεύσιμος ἀνθρώποις ἐγίγνετο.

17. Ὡς δὲ τὸ τοῦ ποταμοῦ οὕτως ἐπορσύνετο, παρηγγύησεν ὁ Κῦρος Πέρσαις χιλιάρχους καὶ πεζῶν καὶ ἱππέων εἰς δύο ἄγοντας τὴν χιλιοστὺν παρεῖναι πρὸς αὐτόν, τοὺς δὲ ἄλλους συμμάχους κατ' οὐρὰν τούτων ἔπεσθαι ἥπερ πρόσθεν τεταγμένους. 18. οἱ μὲν δὴ παρήσαν· ὁ δὲ καταβιβάσας εἰς τὸ ξηρὸν τοῦ ποταμοῦ τοὺς ὑπηρέτας καὶ πεζοὺς καὶ ἱππέας, ἐκέλευσε σκέψασθαι εἰ πορεύσιμον εἴη τὸ ἔδαφος τοῦ ποταμοῦ. 19. ἐπεὶ δὲ ἀπήγγειλαν ὅτι πορεύσιμον εἴη, ἐνταῦθα δὴ συγκαλέσας τοὺς ἡγεμόνας τῶν πεζῶν καὶ ἱππέων ἔλεξε τοιαύδε·

20. Ἄνδρες, ἔφη, φίλοι, ὁ μὲν ποταμὸς ἡμῖν παρακεχώρηκε τῆς εἰς τὴν πόλιν ὁδοῦ. ἡμεῖς δὲ θαρροῦντες εἰσίσωμεν μηδὲν φοβούμενοι εἶσω, ἐννοούμενοι ὅτι οὗτοι ἐφ' οὓς νῦν πορευσόμεθα ἐκεῖνοί εἰσιν οὓς ἡμεῖς καὶ συμμάχους πρὸς ἑαυτοῖς ἔχοντας καὶ ἐγρηγορότας ἅπαντας καὶ νήφοντας καὶ ἐξωπλισμένους καὶ συντεταγμένους ἐνικῶμεν. 21. νῦν δ' ἐπ' αὐτοὺς ἵμεν ἐν ᾧ πολλοὶ μὲν αὐτῶν καθεύδουσι, πολλοὶ δ' αὐτῶν μεθούουσι, πάντες δ' ἀσύντακτοί εἰσιν· ὅταν δὲ αἰσθωνται ἡμᾶς ἔνδον ὄντας, πολὺ ἔτι μᾶλλον ἢ νῦν ἀχρεῖοι ἔσονται ὑπὸ τοῦ ἐκπεπληῆχθαι.

22. Εἰ δέ τις τοῦτο ἐννοεῖται, ὃ δὴ λέγεται φοβερὸν εἶναι τοῖς εἰς πόλιν εἰσιούσι, μὴ ἐπὶ τὰ τέγη ἀναβάντες βάλλωσιν ἔνθεν καὶ ἔνθεν,

opened up the heads of the trenches at the river. 16. As soon as that was done, the water flowed down through the ditches in the night, and the bed of the river, where it traversed the city, became passable for men.

17. When the problem of the river was thus solved, Cyrus gave orders to his Persian colonels, infantry and cavalry, to marshal their regiments two abreast and come to him, and the rest, the allies, to follow in their rear, drawn up as before. 18. They came, according to orders, and he bade his aides, both foot and horse, get into the dry channel of the river and see if it was possible to march in the bed of the river. 19. And when they brought back word that it was, he called together the generals of both infantry and cavalry and spoke as follows :

20. "My friends," said he, "the river has made way for us and given us an entrance into the city. Let us, therefore, enter in with dauntless hearts, fearing nothing and remembering that those against whom we are now to march are the same men that we have repeatedly defeated, and that, too, when they were all drawn up in battle line with their allies at their side, and when they were all wide awake and sober and fully armed; 21. whereas now we are going to fall upon them at a time when many of them are asleep, many drunk, and none of them in battle array. And when they find out that we are inside the walls, in their panic fright they will be much more helpless still than they are now.

Cyrus issues
instructions
for entering
the city

22. "But if any one is apprehensive of that which is said to be a source of terror to those invading a city—namely, that the people may go up

τοῦτο μάλιστα θαρρεῖτε· ἦν γὰρ ἀναβῶσί τινες ἐπὶ τὰς οἰκίας, ἔχομεν σύμμαχον θεὸν Ἡφαιστον. εὐφλεκτα δὲ τὰ πρόθυρα αὐτῶν, φοῖνικος μὲν αἱ θύραι πεποιημέναι, ἀσφάλτῳ δὲ ὑπεκκαύματι κεχρισμένοι.¹ 23. ἡμεῖς δὲ αὖ πολλὴν δᾶδα ἔχομεν, ἢ ταχὺ πολὺ πῦρ τέξεται, πολλὴν δὲ πίτταν καὶ στυππεῖον, ἢ ταχὺ παρακαλεῖ πολλὴν φλόγα· ὥστε ἀνάγκη ἐῖναι ἢ φεύγειν ταχὺ τοὺς ἀπὸ τῶν οἰκιῶν ἢ ταχὺ κατακεκαῦσθαι.

24. Ἄλλ' ἄγετε λαμβάνετε τὰ ὄπλα· ἡγήσομαι δὲ ἐγὼ σὺν τοῖς θεοῖς. ὑμεῖς δ', ἔφη, ὦ Γαδάτα καὶ Γωβρύα, δείκνυτε τὰς ὁδοὺς· ἴστε γάρ· ὅταν δ' ἐντὸς γενώμεθα, τὴν ταχίστην ἄγετε ἐπὶ τὰ βασίλεια.

25. Καὶ μὲν, ἔφασαν οἱ ἀμφὶ τὸν Γωβρύαν, οὐδὲν ἂν εἴη θαυμαστὸν εἰ καὶ ἄκλειστοι αἱ πύλαι αἱ τοῦ βασιλείου εἶεν ὡς ἐν κώμῳ· δειπνεῖ² γὰρ ἡ πόλις πᾶσα τῇδε τῇ νυκτί. φυλακῇ μέντοι πρὸ τῶν πυλῶν ἐντενξύμεθα· ἔστι γὰρ αἰεὶ τεταγμένη.

Οὐκ ἂν μέλλειν³ δέοι, ἔφη ὁ Κῦρος, ἀλλ' ἰέναι, ἵνα ἀπαρασκεύους ὡς μάλιστα λάβωμεν τοὺς ἄνδρας.

26. Ἐπεὶ δὲ ταῦτα ἐρρήθη, ἐπορεύοντο· τῶν δὲ ἀπαντῶντων οἱ μὲν ἀπέθνησκον παιόμενοι, οἱ δὲ ἔφευγον πάλιν εἴσω, οἱ δὲ ἐβόων· οἱ δ' ἀμφὶ τὸν Γωβρύαν συνεβόων αὐτοῖς, ὡς κωμασταὶ

¹ κεχρισμένοι Cobet, most Edd. ; κεχρισμένοι MSS., Breitenbach.

² ὡς . . . δειπνεῖ Hug ; ὡς . . . δοκεῖ xzV, Dindorf, Breitenbach ; κωμοδοκεῖ γ ; κωμάζει Stephanus, Marchant, Gemoll.

³ ἂν μέλλειν Muret, Edd. ; ἀμελεῖν z ; ἂν ἀμελεῖν xy.

on the house-tops and hurl down missiles right and left, you need not be in the least afraid of that; for if any do go up upon their houses, we have a god on our side, Hephaestus. And their porticoes are very inflammable, for the doors are made of palm-wood and covered with bituminous varnish which will burn like tinder; 23. while we, on our side, have plenty of pine-wood for torches, which will quickly produce a mighty conflagration; we have also plenty of pitch and tow, which will quickly spread the flames everywhere, so that those upon the house-tops must either quickly leave their posts or quickly be consumed.

24. "But come, to arms! and with the help of the gods I will lead you on. And do you, Gadatas and Gobryas, show the streets, for you are familiar with them. And when we get inside the walls, lead us by the quickest route to the royal palace."

25. "Aye," answered Gobryas and his staff, "in view of the revelry, it would not be at all surprising if the gates leading to the palace were open, for all the city is feasting this night. Still, we shall find a guard before the gates, for one is always posted there."

"We must lose no time, then," said Cyrus. "Forward, that we may catch the men as unprepared as we can."

26. When these words were spoken, they advanced. And of those they met on the way, some fell by their swords, some fled back into their houses, some shouted to them; and Gobryas and his men shouted

Babylon
falls

ὄντες καὶ αὐτοί· καὶ ἰόντες ἢ ἐδύναντο [ὥς]¹ τάχιστα ἐπὶ τοῖς βασιλείοις ἐγένοντο. 27. καὶ οἱ μὲν σὺν τῷ Γωβρύᾳ καὶ Γαδάτα τεταγμένοι κεκλειμένας εὐρίσκουσι τὰς πύλας τοῦ βασιλείου· οἱ δὲ ἐπὶ τοὺς φύλακας ταχθέντες ἐπεισπίπτουσιν αὐτοῖς πίνουσι πρὸς φῶς πολὺ, καὶ εὐθύς ὥς πολεμίοις ἐχρῶντο αὐτοῖς. 28. ὥς δὲ κραυγὴ καὶ κτύπος ἐγίγνετο, αἰσθόμενοι οἱ ἔνδον τοῦ θορύβου, κελεύσαντος τοῦ βασιλέως σκέψασθαι τί εἴη τὸ πρᾶγμα, ἐκθέουσί τινες ἀνοίξαντες τὰς πύλας. 29. οἱ δ' ἀμφὶ τὸν Γαδάταν ὥς εἶδον τὰς πύλας χαλώσας εἰσπίπτουσιν καὶ τοῖς πάλιν φεύγουσιν εἴσω ἐφεπόμενοι καὶ παίοντες ἀφικνοῦνται πρὸς τὸν βασιλέα· καὶ ἤδη ἐστηκότα αὐτὸν καὶ ἐσπασμένον ὃν εἶχεν ἀκινάκην εὐρίσκουσι. 30. καὶ τοῦτον μὲν οἱ σὺν Γαδάτᾳ καὶ Γωβρύᾳ ἐχειροῦντο· καὶ οἱ σὺν αὐτῷ δὲ ἀπέθνησκον, ὁ μὲν προβαλόμενός τι, ὁ δὲ φεύγων, ὁ δέ γε καὶ ἀμυνόμενος ὅτῳ ἐδύνατο.

31. Ὁ δὲ Κῦρος διέπεμπε τὰς τῶν ἱππέων τάξεις κατὰ τὰς ὁδοὺς καὶ προεῖπεν οὓς μὲν ἔξω λαμβάνοιεν κατακαίνειν, τοὺς δ' ἐν ταῖς οἰκίαις κηρύττειν τοὺς Συριστὶ ἐπισταμένους ἔνδον μένειν· εἰ δέ τις ἔξω ληφθείη, ὅτι θανάτωσσιτο.

32. Οἱ μὲν δὴ ταῦτ' ἐποίουν. Γαδάτας δὲ καὶ Γωβρύας ἦκον· καὶ θεοὺς μὲν πρῶτον προσεκύουν, ὅτι τετιμωρημένοι ἦσαν τὸν ἀνόσιον βασιλέα, ἔπειτα δὲ Κύρου κατεφίλουν καὶ χεῖρας

¹ ὥς MSS.; [ὥς] Hug, Etonensis 1613, Edd.

back to them, as if they were fellow-revellers. They advanced as fast as they could and were soon at the palace. 27. And Gobryas and Gadatas and their troops found the gates leading to the palace locked, and those who had been appointed to attack the guard fell upon them as they were drinking by a blazing fire, and without waiting they dealt with them as with foes. 28. But, as a noise and tumult ensued, those within heard the uproar, and at the king's command to see what the matter was, some of them opened the gates and ran out. 29. And when Gadatas and his men saw the gates open they dashed in in pursuit of the others as they fled back into the palace, and dealing blows right and left they came into the presence of the king; and they found him already risen with his dagger in his hand. 30. And Gadatas and Gobryas and their followers overpowered him; and those about the king perished also, one where he had sought some shelter, another while running away, another while actually trying to defend himself with whatever he could.

Gobryas and
Gadatas
avenge their
wrongs

31. Cyrus then sent the companies of cavalry around through the streets and gave them orders to cut down all whom they found out of doors, while he directed those who understood Assyrian to proclaim to those in their houses that they should stay there, for if any one should be caught outside, he would be put to death.

32. While they were thus occupied, Gadatas and Gobryas came up; and first of all they did homage to the gods, seeing that they had avenged themselves

καὶ πόδας, πολλὰ δακρύνοντες ἅμα χαρᾷ [καὶ εὐφραινόμενοι].¹

33. Ἐπεὶ δὲ ἡμέρα ἐγένετο καὶ ἤσθοντο οἱ τὰς ἄκρας ἔχοντες ἐαλωκυῖάν τε τὴν πόλιν καὶ τὸν βασιλέα τεθνηκότα, παραδιδόασι καὶ τὰς ἄκρας.

34. ὁ δὲ Κῦρος τὰς μὲν ἄκρας εὐθὺς παρελίμβανε καὶ φρουράρχους τε καὶ φρουροὺς εἰς ταύτας ἀνέπεμπε, τοὺς δὲ τεθνηκότας θάπτειν ἐφῆκε τοῖς προσήκουσιν· τοὺς δὲ κήρυκας κηρύττειν ἐκέλευσεν ἀποφέρειν πάντας τὰ ὅπλα Βαβυλωνίου· ὅπου δὲ ληφθήσονται ὅπλα ἐν οἰκίᾳ, προηγόρευεν ὥς πάντες οἱ ἔνδον ἀποθανοῖντο. οἱ μὲν δὴ ἀπέφερον, ὁ δὲ Κῦρος ταῦτα μὲν εἰς τὰς ἄκρας κατέθετο, ὥς εἴη ἔτοιμα, εἴ τί ποτε δέοι χρῆσθαι.

35. Ἐπεὶ δὲ ταῦτ' ἐπέπρακτο, πρῶτον μὲν τοὺς μάγους καλέσας, ὥς δοριαλώτου τῆς πόλεως οὔσης ἀκροθίνια τοῖς θεοῖς καὶ τεμένει ἐκέλευσεν ἐξελεῖν· ἐκ τούτου δὲ καὶ οἰκίας διεδίδου καὶ ἀρχεῖα τούτοις οὗσπερ κοινῶνας ἐνόμιζε τῶν καταπεπραγμένων· οὕτω δὲ διένειμει ὥσπερ ἐδέδοκτο τὰ κράτιστα τοῖς ἀρίστοις. εἰ δέ τις οἶοιτο μείον ἔχειν, διδάσκειν προσιόντας ἐκέλευε.

36. Προεῖπε δὲ Βαβυλωνίοις μὲν τὴν γῆν ἐργάζεσθαι καὶ τοὺς δασμοὺς ἀποφέρειν καὶ θεραπεύειν τούτους οἷς ἕκαστοι αὐτῶν ἐδόθησαν· Πέρσας δὲ τοὺς κοινῶνας καὶ τῶν συμμάχων ὅσοι

¹ καὶ εὐφραινόμενοι MSS., Dindorf, Breitenbach ; bracketed by Lincke, Hug, Marchant, Gemoll.

CYROPAEDIA, VII. v. 32-36

upon the wicked king, and then they kissed Cyrus's hands and his feet with many tears of joy.

33. And when day dawned and those in possession of the citadels discovered that the city was taken and the king slain, they surrendered the citadels, too.

The entire
city yielded
to Cyrus

34. And Cyrus at once took possession of the citadels and sent up to them guards and officers of the guards. As for the dead, he gave their relatives permission to bury them. He furthermore ordered the heralds to make proclamation that all Babylonians deliver up their arms; and he ordered that wherever arms should be found in any house, all the occupants should be put to the sword. So they delivered up their arms and Cyrus stored them in the citadels, so that they might be ready if he ever needed them for use.

35. When all this was finished, he first called the magi and requested them, inasmuch as the city had been taken by the sword, to select sanctuaries and the first fruits of the booty for the gods. Next he distributed the private houses and official residences among those whom he considered to have had a share in what had been achieved; and he made the division in the way that had been decided upon—the best to the most meritorious. And if any one thought he had less than he should, he bade him come and explain his reasons for thinking so.

36. He ordered the Babylonians, moreover, to go on tilling their lands, to pay their tribute, and to serve those to whom they had severally been assigned; and he directed the Persians who had shared in the expedition and as many of the allies as chose

μένειν ἡρῶντο παρ' αὐτῷ ὡς δεσπότας ὧν ἔλαβον προηγόρευε διαλέγεσθαι.

37. Ἐκ δὲ τούτου ἐπιθυμῶν ὁ Κῦρος ἤδη κατασκευάσασθαι καὶ αὐτὸς ὡς βασιλεῖ ἡγεῖτο πρέπειν, ἔδοξεν αὐτῷ τοῦτο σὺν τῇ τῶν φίλων γνώμῃ ποιῆσαι, ὡς ὅτι ἡκιστα ἂν ἐπιφθόνως σπάνιός τε καὶ σεμνὸς φανείη. ὥδε οὖν ἐμύχανατο τοῦτο. ἅμα τῇ ἡμέρᾳ στὰς ὅπου ἔδόκει ἐπιτήδειον εἶναι προσεδέχετο τὸν βουλούμενον λέγειν τι καὶ ἀποκρινάμενος ἀπέπεμπεν. 38. οἱ δ' ἄνθρωποι ὡς ἔγνωσαν ὅτι προσδέχοιτο, ἦκον ἀμήχανοι τὸ πλῆθος· καὶ ὠθουμένων περὶ τοῦ προσελθεῖν μηχανή τε πολλή καὶ μάχη ἦν. 39. οἱ δὲ ὑπηρέται ὡς ἐδύναντο διακρίναντες προσίεσαν.¹

Ὅποτε δὲ τις καὶ τῶν φίλων διωσάμενος τὸν ὄχλον προφανείη, προτείνων ὁ Κῦρος τὴν χεῖρα προσήγετο αὐτοὺς καὶ οὕτως ἔλεγεν· Ἄνδρες φίλοι, περιμένετε, ἕως ἂν² τὸν ὄχλον διωσώμεθα· ἔπειτα δὲ καθ' ἡσυχίαν συγγενησόμεθα. οἱ μὲν δὴ φίλοι περιέμενον, ὁ δ' ὄχλος πλείων καὶ πλείων ἐπέρρει, ὥστ' ἔφθασεν ἐσπέρα γενομένη πρὶν τοῖς φίλοις αὐτὸν σχολάσαι [καὶ]³ συγγενέσθαι. 40. οὕτω δὴ ὁ Κῦρος λέγει, Ὡρα,⁴ ἔφη, ὦ ἄνδρες, νῦν μὲν [καιρὸς]⁵ διαλυθῆναι αὐριον δὲ πρὶν ἔλθετε· καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼ βούλομαι ὑμῖν τι διαλεχθῆναι.

¹ προσίεσαν Stephanus, Edd.; προσήεσαν MSS.

² ἂν Hertlein, Hug, Marchant, Gemoll; not in MSS.. Dindorf, Breitenbach.

³ καὶ MSS., Edd.; bracketed by Gemoll.

⁴ Ὡρα Cobet, most Edd.; ἄρα or ἀρα MSS., Breitenbach.

⁵ καιρὸς MSS.; omitted by Cobet, Edd.

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to remain with him to address those who had fallen to their share as a master would his servants.

37. After this, Cyrus conceived a desire to establish himself as he thought became a king, but he decided to do it with the approval of his friends, in such a way that his public appearances should be rare and solemn and yet excite as little jealousy as possible. So he adopted the following plan: at day-break he would take his station in a place that seemed to him to be adapted to the purpose and there receive all who had any matter to bring before him, give them an answer, and send them away. 38. But when people learned that he was holding audience, they came in an unmanageable throng, and as they crowded up to get in there was no end of trickery and contention. 39. And his attendants would admit them, making the best discrimination they could.

But whenever any of his personal friends managed to push their way through the throng and catch his eye, Cyrus would stretch out his hand, draw them up to him, and say: "Just wait, friends, until we get rid of the crowd, and then we will enjoy each other's company quietly." So his friends would wait, but the throng would stream in greater and greater, so that evening would set in before he had leisure to share his friends' company. 40. So Cyrus would say: "Gentlemen, it is now time to separate; come to-morrow morning; for I, too, have something to talk over with you."

Cyrus holds
court

His
personal
friends are
crowded out

Ἀκούσαντες ταῦτα οἱ φίλοι ἄσμενοι ὥχοντο ἀποθέοντες, δίκην δεδωκότες ὑπὸ πάντων τῶν ἀναγκαίων. καὶ τότε μὲν οὕτως ἐκοιμήθησαν.

41. Τῇ δ' ὑστεραίᾳ ὁ μὲν Κῦρος παρῆν εἰς τὸ αὐτὸ χωρίον, ἀνθρώπων δὲ πολὺ πλεῖον πλῆθος περιειστήκει βουλομένων προσιέναι, καὶ πολὺ πρότερον ἢ οἱ φίλοι παρῆσαν. ὁ οὖν Κῦρος περισησάμενος τῶν ξυστοφόρων Περσῶν κύκλον μέγαν εἶπε μηδένα παριέναι ἢ τοὺς φίλους τε καὶ ἄρχοντας τῶν Περσῶν τε καὶ τῶν συμμάχων.

42. ἐπεὶ δὲ συνῆλθον οὗτοι, ἔλεξεν ὁ Κῦρος αὐτοῖς τοιάδε· Ἄνδρες φίλοι καὶ σύμμαχοι, τοῖς μὲν θεοῖς οὐδὲν ἂν ἔχοιμεν μέμψασθαι τὸ μὴ οὐχὶ μέχρι τούδε πάντα ὅσα ἡνύχόμεθα καταπεπραχέναι. εἰ μέντοι τοιοῦτον ἔσται τὸ μέγала πράττειν ὥστε μὴ οἷόν τ' εἶναι μήτε ἀμφ' αὐτὸν σχολὴν ἔχειν μήτε μετὰ τῶν φίλων εὐφρανθῆναι, ἐγὼ μὲν χαίρειν ταύτην τὴν εὐδαιμονίαν κελεύω.

43. ἐνενοήσατε γάρ, ἔφη, καὶ χθὲς δήπου ὅτι ἔωθεν ἀρξάμενοι ἀκούειν τῶν προσιόντων οὐκ ἐλήξαμεν πρόσθεν ἐσπέρας· καὶ νῦν ὁρᾶτε τούτους ἄλλους πλείονας τῶν χθὲς παρόντας¹ ὥς πράγματα ἡμῖν παρέξοντας. 44. εἰ οὖν τις τούτοις ὑφέξει ἑαυτόν, λογίζομαι μικρὸν μὲν τι ὑμῖν μέρος ἐμοῦ μετεσόμενον, μικρὸν δέ τι ἐμοὶ ὑμῶν· ἐμαυτοῦ μέντοι σαφῶς οἶδ' ὅτι οὐδ' ὅτιοῦν μοι μετέσται.

45. Ἔτι δ', ἔφη, καὶ ἄλλο ὁρῶ γελοῖον πρᾶγμα, ἐγὼ γὰρ δήπου ὑμῖν μὲν ὥσπερ εἰκὸς διάκειμαι· τούτων δὲ τῶν περιεστηκότων ἢ τινα ἢ οὐδένα

¹ παρόντας yG, Edd.; παρόντων xAHV.